Akoizo Original Practice - 2027 Rotation Form 5 - Answer key

Division C | Astronomy | 50-minute written practice

Original Akoizo curriculum practice. This is not a historical tournament paper. Written build, CAD, lab and communication exercises supplement real practical preparation.

ANSWER KEY - Review only after submitting.

1. (2 points) Astronomical metals are…

Unit: Galaxies, stellar populations, and the interstellar medium.
Worked-case data: A region is dark in visible light but bright in infrared and contains embedded young sources. Explain without declaring it empty.

A. All solids only

B. Only charged atoms

C. Elements heavier than helium

D. Only iron and nickel

Correct: C

2. (2 points) A giant can cool at the surface while brightening because…

Unit: Cloud collapse and mass-dependent stellar evolution.
Worked-case data: A toy main-sequence model uses L □ M^3·^5 and lifetime □ M/L. Compare a 2 Msun star with the Sun.

A. Temperature has no effect

B. Its area becomes zero

C. Its radius increases strongly

D. Distance must decrease

Correct: C

3. (2 points) False-color blue necessarily means…

Unit: Observational astronomy and the electromagnetic spectrum.
Worked-case data: A star has parallax 50 mas and approximate blackbody temperature 5800 K.

A. A known temperature

B. A nearby object

C. Only the assigned display channel

D. Visible blue starlight

Correct: C

4. (2 points) A flux-limited distant sample favors…

Unit: Advanced graph and image interpretation.
Worked-case data: Two stars have equal effective temperature but luminosities 1 and 100 Lsun. Compare radii.

A. Intrinsically luminous detectable objects

B. Every star equally

C. Only the lowest-mass stars

D. No selection effect

Correct: A

5. (4 points) Calculate Rs for 10 Msun.

Unit: Supernovae, white dwarfs, neutron stars, and black holes.
Worked-case data: Use 3 km per solar mass as a rounded Schwarzschild-radius scale for a 10 Msun nonrotating black hole.

answer: Approximately 30 km using the stated 3 km/Msun approximation. (4 points).

6. (4 points) Why can a white dwarf be hot but faint?

Unit: Stellar properties, fusion, and the H-R diagram.
Worked-case data: A star has radius 2 Rsun and temperature 2 Tsun. Calculate L/Lsun.

answer: Its small radius limits total emitting area despite high surface temperature. (4 points).

7. (4 points) Why not add magnitudes to combine stars?

Unit: Astrophysics equations and quantitative synthesis.
Worked-case data: A source has m = 10 and M = 5, with negligible extinction. Find distance and compare its flux with the same source at 10 pc.

answer: Magnitudes are logarithmic; add linear fluxes, then convert the total back to magnitude. (4 points).

8. (4 points) Why not model a galaxy as one star?

Unit: Galaxies, stellar populations, and the interstellar medium.
Worked-case data: A region is dark in visible light but bright in infrared and contains embedded young sources. Explain without declaring it empty.

answer: Integrated light combines many stellar temperatures, evolutionary stages, gas, and dust with differing attenuation and emission. (4 points).

9. (4 points) Name two turnoff assumptions or corrections.

Unit: Cloud collapse and mass-dependent stellar evolution.
Worked-case data: A toy main-sequence model uses L □ M^3·^5 and lifetime □ M/L. Compare a 2 Msun star with the Sun.

answer: Approximate coeval formation plus stellar-model dependence; distance, extinction, metallicity, binaries, and completeness also matter. (4 points).

10. (6 points) Solve this case and explain your reasoning: A star has parallax 50 mas and approximate blackbody temperature 5800 K.

reasoning: 50 mas = 0.050 arcsec, so d = 20 pc.
Peak wavelength = 2.898 x 10□^3 / 5800 about 5.0 x 10□^7 m.
This is about 500 nm in the wavelength representation; the star still emits across a broad spectrum. (3 points).

conclusion: Distance geometry and spectral temperature are different observations connected by separate models. (3 points).

11. (2 points) A synthetic star has parallax 0.002 arcseconds. Use d(pc)=1/p to find distance.

answer: 500 pc (2 points).

Numerical target 500; absolute tolerance 1. Accepted units: , pc.

12. (2 points) A standard-candle exercise gives apparent magnitude 15, absolute magnitude 5 and negligible extinction. Use m-M=5log10(d/10 pc). Find d.

answer: 1000 pc (2 points).

Numerical target 1000; absolute tolerance 2. Accepted units: , pc.

13. (2 points) A star has twice the reference radius and the same temperature. Find its luminosity ratio using L proportional to R^2 T^4.

answer: 4 (2 points).

Numerical target 4; absolute tolerance 0.008. Accepted units: , .

14. (2 points) Use Wien's constant 2.90e-3 m K for a 5,800 K star. Find peak wavelength.

answer: 5e-7 m (2 points).

Numerical target 5e-07; absolute tolerance 1e-09. Accepted units: , m.

15. (2 points) An artificial galaxy recession speed is 350 km/s. Use H0=70 km/s/Mpc and the nearby linear Hubble law to find distance.

answer: 5 Mpc (2 points).

Numerical target 5; absolute tolerance 0.01. Accepted units: , Mpc.

16. (2 points) A normalized binary exercise has separation 2 AU and period 2 years. Use total mass in solar masses=a^3/P^2. Find total mass.

answer: 2 solar masses (2 points).

Numerical target 2; absolute tolerance 0.004. Accepted units: , solar masses.

17. (2 points) NASA identifies M82 X-2 as an ultraluminous pulsar. What does a coherent rotation-linked pulse train imply about the compact object, and why is luminosity alone insufficient?

answer: The pulsing compact object is a rotating neutron star. High X-ray luminosity by itself does not uniquely establish that a source is a black hole. (2 points).

18. (2 points) SN 2014J is a Type Ia supernova in M82. Explain why standardized Type Ia luminosities can constrain distance and why dust must be considered.

answer: Compare extinction-corrected apparent brightness with calibrated intrinsic luminosity; dust changes observed brightness and color and can bias inferred distance. (2 points).

19. (2 points) GW170817 was observed in gravitational waves and electromagnetic radiation. Explain the value of this multi-messenger evidence for a neutron-star merger.

answer: The signals independently constrain binary inspiral and luminous ejecta/afterglow, linking compact-object dynamics to an electromagnetic counterpart rather than relying on one signal alone. (2 points).

20. (2 points) Synthetic starburst-galaxy case 5: ultraviolet emission and infrared dust emission both increase. Explain why using only visible light can miss part of the recent star formation.

answer: Dust can absorb shorter-wavelength stellar radiation and reradiate energy in the infrared. Multi-wavelength measurements help constrain obscured young populations; separate other heating sources. (2 points).